

computers everywhere. Now, they have taken it up a notch with Google Maps for mobile. The software works mainly through A-GPS (using cell phone towers) to pinpoint your location and provide directions. The maps for India have been updated to a large extent, given the thriving community of users; a few niggles still remain, but they are not significant enough to dismiss this wonderful tool.

Google Latitude: Launched recently, Latitude latches on to Google Maps and makes it more awesome than you ever thought possible. In layman's terms, Latitude tracks your location at all points and shows it on another user's Google Maps. You can set how accurately the software pinpoints you by letting it show a 200-metre circle around where you are; show the city you are in; or, for privacy concerns, not track you at all. Tracking a person with their cell phone isn't always a Big Brother scenario. If your kids have a phone, you would be quite glad to know where they are. "Whr r u?" is the most common SMS we send anyway, so why not find out without the hassle of back-and-forth messages.

Google Calendar: Most phones these days come with a built-in calendar that lets you set birthdays, appointments, etc. But wouldn't you rather have a single calendar database that is always in sync and can be accessed from any device? Having used Google Calendar for ages, we can vouch for its feature-rich interface and awesome performance. And now, you can carry this wonderful utility with you, ensuring you never miss an important date again. The Calendar on your phone and online account can be synced automatically by using Google Sync; although we recommend you try out the GCalSync (www.gcalsync.com) and GooSync (www.goosync.com) tools. GCalSync has versions for two platforms: Blackberry and Java, ensuring it works on almost any phone. We prefer GooSync while running a Windows Mobile phone, although the software is compatible with all Java-based phones as well.

Google News: To always be updated about what's happening in the world, there are few services that match the aggregation abilities of Google News. The mobile version is just a resized